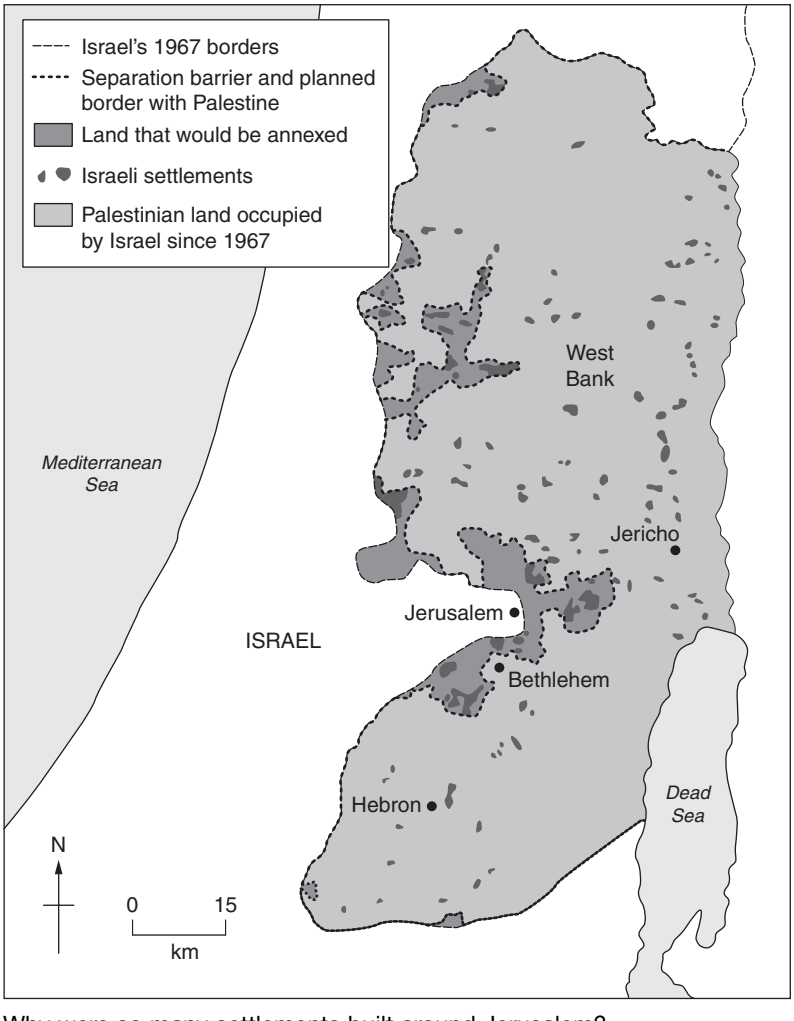


Why were so many settlements built around Jerusalem?

Palestinians used rifles rather than stones and the Israelis used rockets, tanks and helicopters. As the violence continued, Israel started to build a barrier around the West Bank. In some places, it was an eight-metre high concrete wall, in other places it was just a fence. It was reinforced by troops, barbed wire and surveillance cameras. The wall was not built along the **'green line'** that marked the pre-1967 boundary between Israel and the occupied territories, but was further into the West Bank (see the map above).

Israelis said the wall was temporary and purely defensive, to keep out the bombers, but its opponents said it took more land from the Palestinians. They pointed out that many West Bank Jewish settlements were on the Israeli side and that some Palestinian villages found themselves on the 'wrong side'. In other words, the Israelis were creating 'facts on the ground' so that any future Palestinian state would not include all of the West Bank occupied by Israel in the 1967 war.

Key term

'Green line'
The border between Israel and the West Bank before the 1967 Six-Day War.